

enhanced with advent of edge computing. Once the edge computing system comes into play then pre-fabricated data centre concept will follow. Delta is gearing up to develop infrastructure to test and manufacture those in India and is in discussions with many customers who are working closely with Delta at the conceptual stage to address their respective demands. Pre-fabricated segment is something that we are already addressing in the smaller edge which is basically of one to six rack data solution centres. Delta is also working on moving from 1 MW pre-fabricated units to multiple MWs.

What is that gives Delta an edge in the market?

The biggest edge is that Delta is a strongly R&D driven organization with 6-8 percent of its global sales revenue allocated to research and product innovation. We are also the largest ODM and OEM manufacturers of critical components that go into the making of a data centre. Another advantage is our exceptionally competent team that has enriched

our knowledge pool, besides the strong service network backup that we have across the country. The biggest strength, however, are our key customers, who are growing in this segment. Presently, we are focused on addressing further demands of our existing customers rather than scouting the market to fetch new clients. We have also deployed a lot of modular architecture with product offerings that are the most compact in the industry that actually allow the customers to grow as the business grows with them, that is much appreciated by our customers. We see ourselves enhancing the modularity and scalability of our pre-fabricated data centres to further enhance our business.

Could you share about Delta's India vision?

India is one of the sub regions of Delta, which is a huge focus area that exhibits the global management's optimism about India as a potential market. The reason why the company is coming up with an R&D centre at Bengaluru for strengthening its capability within India. We are

also manufacturing in India that makes it viable to have an R&D facility within India. Delta is seeking to invest more than Rs 500 million in India in terms of new factories such as the upcoming global manufacturing unit in Krishnagarhi on the outskirts of Bengaluru, which once completed will have the capacity to not only cater to a huge captive market in India, but to rest of the world as well. The company also has manufacturing facilities in Rudrapur, Uttarakhand, Bengaluru and Gurugram for different products for each business unit. Intelligence gathering at Delta is done in-house as well as from global initiatives where we work closely with research organizations exploring market trends and studying those reports. Attending various events and workshops also helps and most importantly is the feedback of our customers by engaging closely with them which enables us to align our business accordingly. Manufacturing is also set to boom with 'Make in India' of the Indian government giving a boost to our industry.

has a new category this year, targeted at identifying innovations tackling the pandemic (preventive, diagnostic, therapeutic, monitoring, digital connect, work-from-home solutions, etc.). According to Invest India, the country has more than 66,359 DPIIT-recognised start-ups across 642 districts as of March 21, 2022, of which the second highest—9 per cent—are from healthcare and life sciences.

The private sector has also got into the act, in partnership with government agencies and educational institutes. For instance, Krishna Ella, Chairman & MD of Bharat Biotech, is contributing ₹200 crore to a corpus of funds with the Technology Development Board (TDB) of the Ministry of Science & Technology (which will contribute an equal amount) to support start-ups in different fields on relaxed terms and conditions.

The Pfizer Innovation Program,

to support breakthrough healthcare innovations, is supported by Atal Innovation Mission (AIM), NITI Aayog, Accelerating Growth of New India's Innovations (AG-Nii), Foundation for Innovation and Technology Transfer (FITT), IIT Delhi and Social Alpha, a multi-stage innovation curation and venture development platform for science and technology start-ups. Version 1.0 of the programme had incubated nine healthcare innovators and supported 19 IP (intellectual property) filings. Now, in the first year of version 2.0, three winning start-ups each in the areas of oncology and digital health, will receive a grant of up to ₹65 lakh each for product trials, pilot studies and product market launches. This is one of the largest such programmes, both by grant value and partnerships, focussed on incubating and commercialising healthcare start-ups in the country.

AIM and NITI Aayog will provide the start-ups with access to their entire network of incubators and facilities via co-incubation and will also provide technical and strategic advisory to support the programme and the start-ups. IIT Delhi will be the principal incubation partner with support from others.

H **EALTHCARE START-UPS,** backed by digital technology, internet and AI, are now not limited to online pharmacies, drone deliveries of vaccines and medicines, or telemedicine. Several are targeting diverse areas of healthcare, and the approaches and business models are rather interesting.

For example, public health experts have said that the coronavirus infection has long-term effects on mental and physical health. There are known health benefits of well-